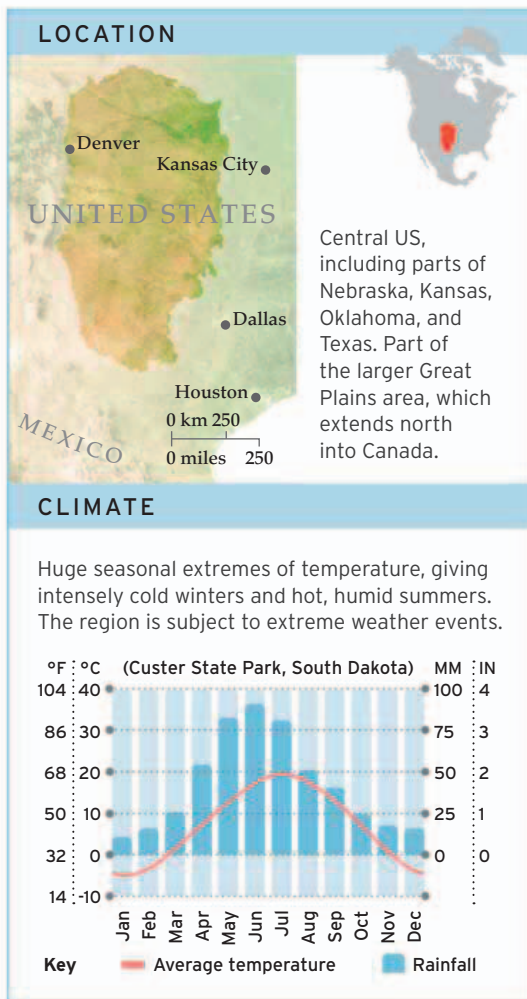
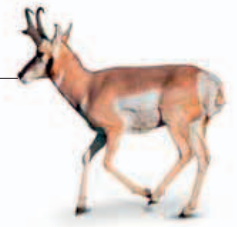




Pronghorn

Antilocapra americana

sensitive nose
picks up scent of
other pronghorns



The pronghorn is the fastest land animal in the Americas, with a top recorded speed of 54 mph (87 km/h). However, its defining feature is its horns. The forked, antlerlike headgear looks like that of a deer, and the pronghorn is also known colloquially as the American antelope. A deer sheds its antlers each year, while an antelope keeps one pair for life; the pronghorn keeps the bony core of the horn for life, shedding the keratin sheath over the bone each winter.

Home on the range

The pronghorn is the sole surviving member of the Antilocaprinae family, which had dozens of species five million years ago. Despite their unique horns, pronghorns share many features with other even-toed ungulates—a herd lifestyle, a diet of leaves and grasses, and long legs. The pronghorn population was devastated by hunting in the 19th century. Today, pronghorn herds survive in the remote parts of the American West, which is appropriate as it is the very beast mentioned in the anthemic western song “Home on the Range.”

- ↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 66–176 lb (30–80 kg)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🌿 Forbs, leaves, grasses
- 🏠



A pronghorn can
**leap 20 ft (6 m) in
a single bound**

▽ RACING AWAY FROM DANGER

Pronghorns live in loose herds, with large males controlling mating territories in summer. They warn each other of danger with snorts and by raising their white rump hairs.

RESTORING DIVERSITY
The diminutive swift fox is a short-grass prairie specialist. Its disappearance from 60 percent of its range reflects wider ecological decline. Projects to restore habitat for this species will benefit others, including groundnesting birds.

Encompasses Tornado Alley

SWIFT FOX

